IRF Report for 2016 Emma de Lacey Mar 2017

WRC2019- Expressions of Interest from:

- Spain, Catalonia Pyrenees
    - Felt by some, including me, to have more interesting terrain from previous European WRCs
    - chosen by 13 votes to 9
- Ukraine
    - Negative comments: close to war, restriction on Russians attending (negated), early March too cold, sandy terrain would leave elephant tracks, terrain too similar to Latvia, Lithuania & Russia
    - Positives: deserved organisers had had unsuccessful bids before, support from great organising team

Timetable for WRCs:

- 2016 – Australasia - Australia
- 2017 – Europe - Latvia
- 2018 – none, Ukraine withdrew its application
- 2019 – Europe - Spain
- 2020 - North America tbc
- 2021 - Other (not Europe, America, Australasia) tbc
- 2022 – Australasia tbc

Discussion around changing the name, "Rogaining":

- Bud Laird says it is a problem in N America – commonly known as a hair restorer, wants a more descriptive name, e.g. "Navigation Racing", "Map Trekking"
- Comments – much work has gone into building the "Rogaine" brand in other countries, "Regaine" not Rogaine for hair product elsewhere
- Consensus to keep "Rogaining" name, North America can use their own terminology but WRCs must be referred to as "Rogaining".

List of IRF Councillors (elected or re-elected):

- President Richard Robinson
- Vice President Lauri Leppik
- Treasurer Rob Gardner
- Technical Manager Sergey Yaschenko
- Promotion/Development Manager will become vacant on 1st March 2017 when Alan Mansfield steps down. Any nominations for this position should be sent to Rod Phillips.
- All other executive positions remain unchanged as they were not up for election this year.

Other Interesting Stuff:

- Survey about setting rogaine courses held (funded by IRF) – I can't find any results from this.
- Chile holding their first rogaine in 2017.
- Estonia think they are holding the first ever skating rogaine in Jan 2018.

IRF Policy Documents (made available on website after I complained to RR): http://rogaining.com/index.php?option=com_content&view=article&id=328:irf-policy-documents&catid=20&Itemid=162

Amendment to Rogaining Rules, passed 30/12/2016:

- Technical Subcommittee developed and approved an amendment to the rules, to clarify whether the checkpoints punched after the general finish time and before the late finish cut-off time shall be included in team's total score.

  Current Wording:

  No team shall start until the organisers announce the start. The event shall finish at the advertised finish time as determined by the organisers' clock. Teams finishing late will be penalised at the rate per minute or part thereof specified in advance by the organisers. Teams finishing more than thirty minutes late shall be deemed ineligible for a placing and their result shall be recorded as LATE.

  New Wording:

  No team shall start until the organisers announce the start. The event shall finish at the advertised finish time as determined by the organisers' clock. Teams finishing late will be penalised at the rate per minute or part thereof specified in advance by the organisers, however any checkpoint visited after the advertised finish time will be included in team's score. Teams finishing more than thirty minutes late shall be deemed ineligible for a placing and their result shall be recorded as LATE.

Geoduck Award 2016 – **Sergey Yaschenko** for outstanding contribution to Rogaining over a prolonged period.

Sergey has a long involvement with navigation and running events. In 2002, Vladimir Gusiatnikov convinced him to participate in the World Rogaining Championships in Lesna in the Czech Republic That was the start of 15 years of involvement in rogaining at all levels. Sergey has been instrumental in Russia becoming one of the powerhouses of world rogaining, with many 24 hour championship rogaines now being held each year. He has strongly supported the growth of the International Rogaining Federation and the development of regular European Championships. He helped to organize the 2008 European Rogaining Championships in Michurinskoe in Russia. In 2012-3, he played a major role in the organization of the World Rogaining Championships in Russia and helped to found the Russian Rogaining Federation. As well as being a top level competitor, Sergey has served on the IRF executive for many years as technical manager.

New NZ IRF Rep: Matt Bixley, as of 11 Jan 2017.